

Fifth Sunday After Pentecost

Dominica Quinta Post Pentecosten

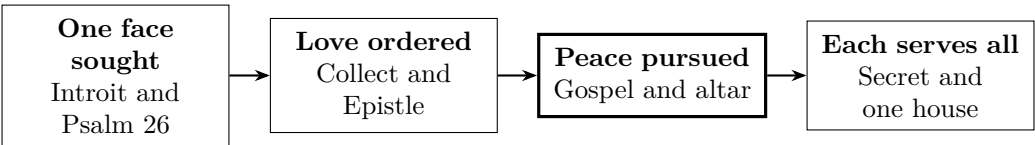
TLM propers: ordered love makes sacrifice truthful and fruitful for all

Proper	TLM text / reference	Scriptural axis	Connection
Introit	<i>Exaudi, Domine, vocem meam</i> (Ps. 26:7, 9)	Urgent prayer to the saving God	The worshipper begins by seeking the divine face and refusing abandonment, not by rehearsing the grievance against a brother.
Collect	<i>Deus, qui diligentibus te bona invisibilia praeparasti</i>	Infused and ordered love	God is asked to pour his love into the heart so he may be loved in all things and above all things.
Epistle	1 Pet. 3:8–15	Unity, compassion, blessing, peace	Peter gives charity a social form: reject retaliation, govern speech, seek peace, and sanctify Christ in the heart.
Gradual	<i>Protector noster aspice, Deus</i> (Ps. 83:10, 9)	God's searching, protecting gaze	Before Christ searches anger and contempt, the Church places herself under God's searching and protecting gaze.
Alleluia	<i>Domine, in virtute tua laetabitur rex</i> (Ps. 20:1)	Strength, salvation, joy	Peace is sought from received strength rather than the power gained by winning a quarrel.
Gospel	Matt. 5:20–24	Anger, contempt, altar, reconciliation	The altar requires truthful charity: the worshipper who has injured a brother must take the initiative toward reconciliation.
Offertory	<i>Benedicam Dominum</i> (Ps. 15:7–8)	God kept before the eyes	Offering begins by displacing the self-justifying gaze and placing the Lord at the worshipper's right hand.
Secret	<i>Propitiare, Domine, supplicationibus nostris ... has oblationes ... benignus assume ... quod singuli obtulerunt ... cunctis proficiat ad salutem</i>	Each offers; all receive benefit	God is asked to receive the gifts of his servants so that what each offers in honor of his Name may profit everyone unto salvation.
Communion	<i>Unam petii a Domino</i> (Ps. 26:4)	One desire, one house	Desire for God's house gathers the divided heart toward the communion that resentment contradicts.
Postcommunion	<i>Quos caelesti, Domine, dono satiasti</i>	Hidden cleansing and protection	Those fed by the heavenly gift ask cleansing from hidden faults and freedom from the enemy's snares.

Sense	Synthesis
Literal	Matthew moves from murder to anger and contempt, then commands the worshipper whose brother has something against him to seek reconciliation before offering; Peter commands concord, compassion, blessing, disciplined speech, and pursuit of peace.
Allegorical	The altar finds fulfillment in Christ's sacrifice and the Church's Eucharistic offering. Communion in Christ's one body exposes the contradiction of cherishing contempt while receiving the sacrament of unity.
Moral	The hearer must govern speech, refuse retaliation, acknowledge harm done, and take the first truthful and prudent step toward peace; reconciliation does not require denial of wrong or unsafe contact.
Anagogical	Ordered love and reconciled worship prepare the soul for the one house and final vision of God, where contempt cannot enter and communion is complete.

One Love, One Peace, One Ecclesial Offering

The Collect gives this Sunday its interior architecture. God is asked to pour his love into the heart so that he may be loved *in all things and above all things*. The prayer neither competes with love of the neighbor nor leaves every affection on one level. It asks that love of God become the order within which the brother is loved truthfully, anger is judged, peace is pursued, and each person’s gift is turned toward the salvation of all.



Editorial liturgical synthesis. The sequence above belongs to this guide’s reading of the appointed formulary. The Fathers below directly expound particular biblical texts or supply doctrinal illumination; none is being presented as an author of this Roman Mass.

Grace gives both order and endurance
The Collect’s principal actor is God: he prepares invisible goods, infuses love, and grants that the worshippers may obtain promises surpassing desire. Reconciliation is not a technique by which autonomous wills manufacture communion. It is a fruit of charity received, ordered, and brought into action.

Augustine: The Order of Love

In *De doctrina christiana* I.22–29 Augustine asks what it means to love God, oneself, the neighbor, and the body in a just order. His vocabulary of “enjoyment” and “use” can mislead a modern reader unless its destination is retained: God alone is the unchangeable good in whom beatitude rests, while persons are loved in their common relation to him and are helped toward sharing that same good.

Locus	Augustine’s argument	Relation to the Collect	Guardrail
I.22.20–21	Neither self nor neighbor is to become the final resting place of desire. The whole current of affection is directed toward God, and the neighbor is loved for God’s sake.	“Above all things” identifies the unchangeable good; “in all things” carries every rightful love into that one current.	Loving a person for God’s sake does not license exploitation. The neighbor is truly loved as a person capable of sharing beatitude in God; Augustine’s <i>uti</i> refers love toward that final good.
I.23–26	Four objects belong within love: God above us, ourselves, the neighbor alongside us, and the body beneath the rational soul. Sin disorders these relations by seeking domination over equals or by mistaking corrupt habit for bodily nature.	Infused charity heals a hierarchy of affections rather than suppressing creaturely goods.	Ordered love is not contempt for the body, personality, or created bonds; it opposes the habit that makes a lower good rule the whole.

Locus	Augustine's argument	Relation to the Collect	Guardrail
I.27.28	A just person loves what ought to be loved and neither gives greater, lesser, nor equal weight contrary to the object's true order. Every human being is loved as human; no sinner is loved precisely as sinner.	The Collect asks for more than intensity. It asks for a truthful measure and direction of love.	Hatred of evil is not hatred of the person. Correcting disorder must remain ordered toward the person's good in God.
I.28–29	All are to be loved, although finite agents cannot give the same concrete help to everyone. Circumstance identifies particular responsibilities; the desired end is that all join in loving God.	The heart can be universal in charity while action remains particular and responsible.	"All" does not erase the claims of the actual brother, nor does proximity make that brother the final end of desire.

Augustine therefore supplies the bridge among the Collect, Gospel, and Secret. The person at the altar cannot appeal to universal benevolence while refusing the particular brother whose grievance has been remembered. Yet repair is not confined to a private dyad: rightly ordered love desires that both persons, and finally all, share the one good who is God.

Neither absorption nor rivalry

Love of God and neighbor are not two quantities competing for a fixed emotional supply. Augustine says that the current of love for self and neighbor is borne into love of God. The neighbor is not dissolved into an idea of God; he is loved more truly as one who can share in God, and his concrete need lays claim upon the Christian's finite service.

Psalm 26: Interior Cry, Face, and One House

The Introit and Communion come from the same psalm. Augustine's exposition directly comments on their appointed verses, though not on their later placement at entrance and Communion.

Verse and proper	Augustine's direct exegesis	Spiritual movement	Liturgical application status
Psalm 26:7, Introit	In <i>Exposition on Psalm 26</i> , 7, the voice God hears is interior: a strong intention addressed to his ears and dependent upon mercy.	The worshipper turns affliction into prayer rather than an imagined prosecution of the brother.	Applying the verse to this Mass's coming Gospel is editorial synthesis.
Psalm 26:8–9, Introit context	The heart seeks not a reward apart from God but God's own countenance; perseverance requires divine help, because the mortal seeks the Eternal as one needing healing.	Desire is purified from using God as an ally for a lesser victory. The face itself becomes the sought good.	This is documented same-psalm context, since verse 8 is implicit in the Introit's larger chant unit.
Psalm 26:4, Communion	The one petition is to remain within the worldwide unity and truth of faith, to behold God's delight face to face, and finally to be made his immortal temple.	The one desired house holds ecclesial perseverance and final vision together.	Augustine directly explains the Communion verse; relating it to reception at this Mass remains liturgical synthesis.

The psalm's arc is thus not solitude against community. The heart seeks God himself and, for that very reason, asks to remain within the one house of faith. The Communion antiphon does not allow reconciliation to end as a negotiated ceasefire. Its horizon is shared dwelling, contemplation, and incorporation as God's temple.

Peter: Blessing and the Pursuit of Peace

First Peter gives ordered love an ecclesial and bodily form: unity of mind, compassion, brotherly charity, mercy, humility, refusal of retaliation, guarded speech, active goodness, and pursued peace. The apostle then commands the faithful to sanctify Christ in their hearts. Interior allegiance and social action belong to one movement.

Petrine command	Disorder refused	Positive form of charity
Be of one mind, compassionate, loving as brethren	Isolation, indifference, and the assumption that another's suffering is irrelevant.	Ecclesial concord does not require sameness of temperament; it requires shared orientation and suffering-with.
Do not return evil or reviling; bless	Retaliation lets the offender determine the Christian's speech and action.	Blessing invokes the good from God and remembers the inherited vocation to blessing.
Restrain tongue and lips	Peace cannot coexist with speech designed to deceive, humiliate, or prolong enmity.	Truthful restraint makes room for action directed toward good rather than verbal mastery.
Turn from evil, do good; seek peace and pursue it	Peace treated as a mood, a passive absence of conflict, or another person's duty.	The repeated verbs give peace a strenuous shape: departure, good action, search, and pursuit.
Sanctify Christ in the heart	A merely horizontal settlement detached from worship.	Christ becomes the heart's governing holiness, from which a meek and truthful answer can proceed.

The Venerable Bede — direct commentary on 1 Peter 3

In *Super epistolas Catholicas*, *In Primam Petri* III, Bede reads Peter's differentiated Christians as gathered into one heart in the Lord's faith. Blessing already rehearses their inheritance; persecutors may inflict loss or torture but cannot take the final good from those who persevere; sanctifying Christ inwardly gives courage to explain hope with humility and a good conscience. Bede's lemma reads *In fide autem*, not the Mass text's *in oratione estote*; this is direct commentary on the chapter, not evidence that every Latin form is identical.

Peter's words "seek peace and pursue it" quote Psalm 33. Jerome's *Letter 125.14* is therefore a documented same-psalm reception, not direct commentary on First Peter. Jerome insists that leaving evil requires doing its contrary good, and that peace must be chased even when it seems to flee. His monastic setting differs from this Sunday, but the active force of "pursue" is exact.

Peace is not moral vagueness

Peter's sequence joins peace to truthful speech, departure from evil, positive good, and a clean conscience. The command does not call falsehood true, erase justice, or make coerced contact the measure of forgiveness. It does forbid cherished retaliation and indifference to repair. Prudence may govern the manner of approach; it cannot baptize enmity as peace.

Matthew 5: From the Root to the Altar

Matthew 5:20–24 belongs to Christ's account of the righteousness that exceeds that of the scribes and Pharisees. The movement is inward and then sacramental: from homicide to anger, from anger to contemptuous address, from speech to remembered grievance, and from remembered grievance to interrupted offering and urgent reconciliation.

Witness and locus	Direct reading of the Gospel	Sacrificial claim	Interpretive precision
St. John Chrysostom, Homily 16 on Matthew, 6, 9–12	The greater righteousness does not reject the old law but brings it to stricter perfection. Contemptuous speech matters because small words feed the fire of enmity and can grow into greater violence.	Christ permits divine service to be interrupted because reconciled charity is itself sacrifice; without charity the other gift is not received.	Chrysostom first addresses the wrongdoer, then widens the urgency so that the injured person also refuses prolonged enmity. This does not make guilt symmetrical.
St. Augustine, On the Sermon on the Mount I.9.21–I.10.28	The linked sayings trace anger retained in the mind, contempt expressed, and the humble remedy that cuts off hatred. “Your brother has something against you” directs remembrance toward injury one has caused.	Augustine reads the visible altar together with faith in God’s interior temple: the offerer must approach with a mind free from dissimulation and ask pardon where injury was done.	His discussion of an absent brother prevents a wooden demand to abandon a gift indefinitely; interior humility must be real and should issue in truthful approach when possible.

Chrysostom protects the objective seriousness of the altar: Christ does not abolish sacrifice but refuses its use as refuge from a ruptured charity. Augustine protects the direction of examination: the text first makes the offerer remember what the brother has *against him*, not construct a catalogue of the brother’s offenses. Together they turn memory from accusation to responsibility.

The altar reveals rather than conceals
The gift lying before the altar makes delay visible. The worshipper cannot purchase innocence by offering, but neither is the altar opposed to reconciliation. Christ orders the offering by ordering the offerer toward the brother, so that sacrificial worship and charity may become one truthful act.

The Secret: What Each Offers Profits All

The Secret does not dissolve individual agency into an anonymous collective. It names individual offering distributively and then asks for universal ecclesial fruit.

Latin hinge	Grammatical force	Ecclesial movement
<i>has oblationes famulorum famularumque tuarum benignus assume</i>	God is asked mercifully to receive these oblations of his servants, women and men.	Acceptance remains divine gift; offering does not validate itself.
<i>quod singuli obtulerunt</i>	The neuter singular <i>quod</i> gathers the offered reality, while distributive <i>singuli</i> preserves “each one.”	Personal histories, responsibilities, and acts are not erased at the altar.
<i>ad honorem nominis tui</i>	The honor of God’s Name is the offering’s governing reference.	Augustine’s order of love reaches sacrificial form: the gift is not directed to private prestige or control.
<i>cunctis proficiat ad salutem</i>	The prayer asks that it profit everyone unto salvation.	What each gives is received into an end no isolated offerer can possess privately.

St. Cyprian — <i>On the Lord's Prayer</i>, 8
Cyprian does not comment on this Secret, but he provides close ecclesial illumination. Christian prayer says “our,” “us,” and “we” because the people are one; Christ teaches each Christian not to pray for self alone but for all. Individual voices are not silenced. Like the Three Children praying as from one mouth, they become a concordant common petition. This closely clarifies the Secret’s passage from <i>singuli</i> to <i>cunctis</i> .
St. Augustine — <i>City of God</i> X.5–6
Augustine supplies sacrificial doctrine rather than direct exposition of the oration. True sacrifices are works of mercy ordered to holy fellowship with God; body and soul are offered as the mind is transformed; and the whole redeemed city is offered through Christ the High Priest. The Secret’s many individual offerings can therefore serve all because the offerers are gathered into an ecclesial sacrifice whose unity is Christ’s.

From the Lord Before the Eyes to Hidden Cleansing

The Offertory keeps the Lord always before the worshipper and at his right hand. That placement dislodges the self-justifying gaze: the person who has stood under God’s searching protection in the Gradual now offers under divine counsel rather than imagined moral superiority. The Secret asks for reception and common fruit; Communion gathers desire into the one house; the Postcommunion asks the heavenly gift to cleanse hidden faults and guard against the enemy’s snares.

Final proper	Action of grace	Correction of a false conclusion
Offertory	God counsels and stands at the right hand; the offerer blesses rather than self-authorizes.	Seeking reconciliation does not make the worshipper judge over every hidden motive.
Communion	One desire seeks one house, perseverance in faith, and the final vision of God’s delight.	Ecclesial unity is not an accessory to private contemplation.
Postcommunion	Those already fed ask to be cleansed from hidden faults and delivered from snares.	Reception is not proof that self-knowledge is complete or that the worshipper’s side of every conflict is pure.

A patristic listening sequence for the Mass

1. At the Introit, let Augustine's Psalm 26 turn the audible cry into interior intention and the search for advantage into the search for God's face.
2. In the Collect, ask with *De doctrina christiana* for ordered love: God above all, every person loved in relation to him, and particular service within universal charity.
3. In First Peter, hear peace as enacted concord: compassion, blessing, governed speech, positive good, pursuit, and Christ sanctified in the heart.
4. At the Gradual and Alleluia, stand beneath God's protecting gaze and receive strength before Christ exposes anger, contempt, and delayed repair.
5. In the Gospel, let Chrysostom show charity's sacrificial dignity and Augustine redirect memory toward injury one has caused. Do not use the altar to hide from the brother.
6. At the Offertory and Secret, place the Lord before the eyes and hear each offered gift ordered to the honor of God's Name and the salvation of all.
7. At Communion, ask for the one house and face-to-face delight; in the Postcommunion, let the heavenly gift search hidden faults rather than ratify self-certainty.

Source boundaries to retain

- Chrysostom and Augustine on Matthew 5, Bede on 1 Peter 3, and Augustine on Psalm 26 are **direct patristic exegesis** of appointed biblical texts, though not commentaries on this Roman formulary.
- Jerome comments directly on the Psalm 33 verse quoted by First Peter; his use here is a **documented same-psalm reception**, not a commentary on the epistle or Mass.
- Augustine's ordered-love account, Cyprian's common prayer, and Augustine's sacrificial ecclesiology are **doctrinal illumination** of the Collect and Secret.
- The face-heart-peace-offering sequence and the relations among the proper texts are **editorial liturgical syntheses** controlled by their actual wording.

Primary References

- *Missale Romanum* (1962), *Dominica Quinta post Pentecosten*, Introit through Postcommunion; local OCR temporal corpus identified in the README. Latin OCR remains subject to printed-missal verification; psalm numbering follows the Vulgate.
- Holy Scripture: Psalm 26; Psalm 33:13–17; 1 Peter 3:8–15; Matthew 5:17–24.
- St. Augustine, *De doctrina christiana* I.22.20–I.29.30, working public-domain text.
- St. Augustine, *Exposition on Psalm 26*, 4, 7–9, working public-domain text; New Advent's page heading uses Psalm 27.
- St. John Chrysostom, *Homily 16 on Matthew*, 6, 9–12, working public-domain text.
- St. Augustine, *On the Sermon on the Mount* I.9.21–I.10.28, working public-domain text.
- St. Jerome, *Letter 125 to Rusticus*, 14, Psalm 33 and the active pursuit of peace.
- The Venerable Bede, *Super epistolas Catholicas*, In *Primam Petri* III, at 1 Peter 3:8–17, Latin text, PL 93:55D–57C.
- St. Cyprian of Carthage, *On the Lord's Prayer*, 8, public and common prayer; St. Augustine, *City of God* X.5–6, the whole redeemed city offered through the High Priest.